Installing on Linux

Linux has many different distributions, each having its own method of installing software, along with various idiosyncrasies around how it behaves. It would be too difficult to cover them all, so in this section, we'll outline how to get a Rails environment running on Ubuntu Linux. Most of the software we'll install would be needed on any Linux distribution, so if you aren't using Ubuntu, hopefully, this will help you know what you need to set up.

With that disclaimer out of the way, our setup will require a few different steps. First, we'll install some system software that the Ruby and Rails development tools require before finally installing Ruby and Rails.

Installing System Software

The commands that follow assume you're logged in as a user who can execute `sudo`. Also, note that in this case, you may have some software installed already. If you experience problems, you might want to update that software to the latest versions.

Many Ruby libraries are actually wrappers for C libraries, and when you install them, your system will try to build those libraries or build native connectors. This is the main reason we need certain software installed before we get to Ruby. First, refresh the list of packages available for your operating system:

```
$ sudo apt-get update
```

That will produce a large amount of output. Once that's done, we'll install several different libraries and tools. This is what it will look like on Ubuntu and most Debian-based Linuxes:

```
$ sudo apt-get install -y \
```